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Canada

Organization and Classification Program

Reference Guide

Fundamentals of Job Classification



Office of the Chief Human Resources Officer

TABLE OF CONTENTS

PURPOSE	1
INTENDED AUDIENCE.....	1
LEARNING OBJECTIVES	1
CHAPTER 1 – OC WITHIN THE CPA PEOPLE MANAGEMENT FRAMEWORK	2
CHAPTER 2 – THE OC PROGRAM AND ITS FRAMEWORK IN THE CPA	4
2.1 THE OC PROGRAM FRAMEWORK	4
2.2 THE CLASSIFICATION PROGRAM.....	7
2.3 OCCUPATIONAL GROUP STRUCTURE.....	9
CHAPTER 3 – OTHER HR SPECIALTIES AND THEIR LINKS WITH OC	10
3.1 COMPENSATION	10
3.2 STAFFING	10
3.3 LABOUR RELATIONS	11
3.4 HUMAN RESOURCES PLANNING.....	11
3.5 OFFICIAL LANGUAGES.....	11
3.6 TRAINING AND LEARNING.....	12
3.7 EMPLOYMENT EQUITY	12
CHAPTER 4 – OTHER STAKEHOLDERS AND THEIR ROLES	12
4.1 DEPUTY HEADS	12
4.2 HEADS OF HUMAN RESOURCES	13
4.3 MANAGERS	13
4.4 BARGAINING AGENTS (BA).....	14
CHAPTER 5 - INDIVIDUALS WITH OC RESPONSIBILITIES	14
5.1 PERSONS ACCREDITED IN OC WHO HAVE SUB-DELEGATED CLASSIFICATION AUTHORITY	14
5.2 PERSONS TRAINED IN OC	15
5.3 PERSONS TRAINED IN EX GROUP CLASSIFICATION	15
CHAPTER 6 – JOB DESCRIPTIONS	15
6.2 JOB DESCRIPTIONS: ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES	16
6.3 JOB DESCRIPTION LINKS TO HR ACTIVITIES	17
6.4 EFFECTIVE DATES OF JOB DESCRIPTIONS.....	17
6.5 UNIQUE AND STANDARDIZED JOB DESCRIPTIONS	17
CHAPTER 7 - ORGANIZATIONAL CHARTS.....	19
CHAPTER 8 – THE CLASSIFICATION DECISION PROCESS.....	19
8.1 REQUEST SUBMISSION	20
8.2 ANALYSIS OF THE REQUEST	21
8.3 GATHERING ADDITIONAL INFORMATION	21
8.4 JOB EVALUATION	23
8.5 IMPLEMENTATION.....	27
CHAPTER 9 – REVIEW AND UPDATE OF A POSITION	28
9.1 RECLASSIFICATION	28
CHAPTER 10 – FINANCIAL IMPACTS OF ORGANIZATIONAL DESIGN AND CLASSIFICATION	29
CHAPTER 11 – MANAGEMENT DISAGREEMENT WITH A CLASSIFICATION DECISION	29
CHAPTER 12 – GRIEVANCES	30
12.1 CLASSIFICATION GRIEVANCES	30
12.2 LABOUR RELATIONS (LR) GRIEVANCES.....	30

Purpose

This reference guide is an introduction to the Government of Canada [Core Public Administration](#) (CPA) Organization and Classification (OC) Framework. More specifically, its purpose is to:

- Provide an overview of the OC framework, its legislative and policy components, and how it fits into the larger CPA People Management Framework.
- Familiarize [OC advisors](#) with the OC legislative and policy framework in the CPA, and its specifications on roles and sub-delegated responsibilities.
- Explain the process leading to OC decisions, their impacts, and recourse options.

Note: This reference guide pertains to non-EX [occupational groups](#), except where otherwise specified. EX classification is governed by separate policy instruments and processes.

Upon successful completion of the requirements of the Organization and Classification Learning Curriculum, as outlined in the Policy on People Management, candidates will obtain a Treasury Board of Canada Secretariat accreditation number.

Intended Audience

This reference guide is intended for the following:

- New OC trainees, as a preview of the core activities and principles of OC work.
- OC trainees attending the Office of the Chief Human Resources Officer's (OCHRO) Accreditation Training, as a core element of the training alongside the practical, scenario-based elements.
- Accredited OC advisors, as an ongoing reference guide outlining expectations and requirements of the OC Program. It also supports consistency in outcomes while allowing for flexibility in operational approach to organizational activities.
- Stakeholders of the Classification Program, as a part of training requirements associated with their roles, as applicable.

Learning Objectives

At the end of this module, the participant will be able to:

- Recognize and use OC terminology.
- Identify and explain the roles and responsibilities of those directly linked to the Classification Program.
- Identify and explain the roles and responsibilities of OC advisors and the linkages with other human resources (HR) areas and stakeholders as they relate to the Classification Program.
- Identify the mandate, legislative framework, policies and instruments of the Classification Program.
- Identify the main activities associated with the Classification Program.

Chapter 1 – OC Within the CPA People Management Framework

Organization and classification is a key component of the broader Government of Canada People Management Framework in the Core Public Administration (CPA), which consists of more than 80 organizations (primarily ministerial organizations such as departments and agencies) named in Schedules I and IV of the [Financial Administration Act](#).

The [Treasury Board of Canada \(TB\)](#) is a committee of cabinet ministers, which acts as the management board and Employer of the CPA. The TB is responsible for accountability and ethics; financial, personnel and administrative management; comptrollership; approving regulations; and approving most Orders-in-Council (governmental decisions signed by the Governor General). The role of the TB is unique in that through policy instruments, it sets the parameters within which all ministers and deputy heads must exercise their authorities. The TB issues a range of policy instruments which establish requirements, clarify the responsibilities of all parties, and accountabilities.

The [Treasury Board of Canada Secretariat \(TBS\)](#) is the administrative arm of the Treasury Board. The TBS provides advice and recommendations to the TB on how the government spends money on programs and services, how it regulates them, and how it is managed. It ensures that tax dollars are spent wisely and effectively for all Canadians, and provides advice and guidance to the TB on employer policies, directives, tools, and [job evaluation standards](#) (JES).

The [Office of the Chief Human Resources Officer \(OCHRO\)](#), within TBS, is responsible for multiple mandates, including Pension and Benefits, Diversity and Employee Equity, Compensation and Labour Relations, Awards and Recognition, Collective Agreements, and Governance, Planning and Policy. It supports the TB by driving excellence in people management and ensuring the appropriate degree of consistency across the public service. The OCHRO supports public servants in achieving a high-quality workforce and workplace by:

- Setting out mandatory training to exercise the responsibilities described in the [Policy on People Management](#) and supporting instruments.
- Determining the requirements for the OC Learning Curriculum for the CPA.
- Ensuring the integrity and oversight of the OC Program across the CPA.
- Managing a central Employer classification information management system, known as the Position and Classification Information System Plus (PCIS+), to which departments are mandated to upload [job](#) information, and to maintain that information.

OCHRO fulfills this mandate in a manner that is compatible with the primary accountabilities and responsibilities of deputy heads.

Deputy heads (DH) are the most senior civil servants in any government organization. While their titles can vary, most use **deputy minister (DM)**, while others use vice-president, chief executive officers, or commissioner, depending on the type of organization. Deputy heads take political direction from a minister of the Crown, who is typically an elected member of Parliament and responsible for the organization.

Ministers, DHs and the TB each have distinct authorities for public sector management. Ministers and DHs have authority to manage the people, resources, and activities of their organizations towards the objectives set out in

legislative mandates and government policy. Deputy heads manage by exercising authorities assigned to them by a person (for example a minister), by a body (for example the [Public Service Commission of Canada \(PSC\)](#)), or by statutory instrument (for example the [Financial Administration Act \(FAA\)](#)). Finally, the TB, as the management board of the CPA, has the authority to ensure that the government is managed in a coherent and effective manner. A high-level representation of this governance structure is shown in Figure 1.1.

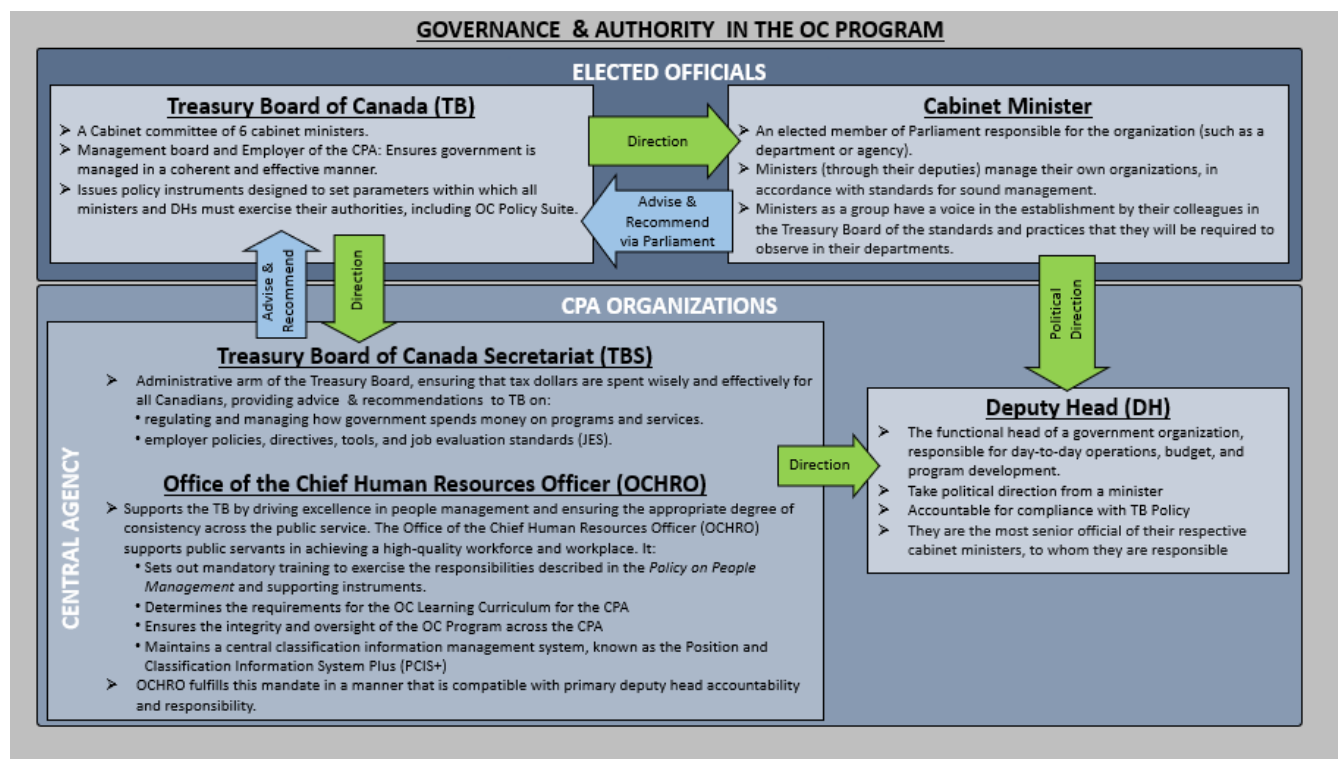


Figure 1.1 OC Governance and Authority Across the CPA

Modern public sector management practices are set out in the [Management Accountability Framework \(MAF\)](#), which establishes general expectations of DHs. The MAF describes the general and interdependent management practices, such as accountability, stewardship, values, and performance required to create a productive and innovative working environment. The MAF also serves as a tool for both TB and organizations to assess management performance and influences organizational priorities.

Beyond the general expectations of the MAF, certain management functions must be conducted according to specific rules that are set out in legislation and policies. The TB, supported by the TBS, approves policy instruments pursuant to the [Financial Administration Act \(FAA\)](#) and more than [20 other pieces of enabling legislation](#) that provide it with the authority to control and report on public expenditures, and establish pay rates and benefits for government employees as well as rules for managing employees and public resources.

The legislation is applied via policies and regulations; those associated with OC are addressed in the [Policy on People Management](#). This policy provides DHs with support and direction in developing and sustaining a high-performing workforce that ensures good governance and service to Canadians, and an inclusive, safe, and barrier-free workplace that embodies public service values including respect for people and democracy,

integrity, stewardship and excellence in its actions and decisions. People management includes organizational design and classification, compensation, staffing, labour relations, executive management, values and ethics, diversity and inclusion, and occupational health and safety.

Chapter 2 – The OC Program and its Framework in the CPA

The OC program is an integral component of the broader CPA people management agenda, contributing directly to well managed organizations. The program establishes the principles of the sound organization and measurement of work in the CPA; supports the creation of a hierarchy of work to which compensation can be mapped. It provides a policy framework, direction and tools to foster the prudent management of the wage bill through appropriate [classification decisions](#) and classification relativity across the CPA.

This chapter outlines the foundations of the OC program and its framework, explaining its legislative and policy components, and associated tools.

2.1 The OC Program Framework

2.1.1 The *Financial Administration Act* (FAA)

The authority to make classification decisions is conferred by the [Financial Administration Act](#). Section 11.1 (1) b of this act states that the TB may provide for the classification of [positions](#) and persons employed in the public service, conferring the authority to organize work and classify positions to the Employer. The TB, in turn, authorizes DHs to classify positions in their organizations via the requirements set out in the [Policy on People Management](#) and its supporting tools.

2.1.2 The *Pay Equity Act* (PEA)

The purpose of the [Pay Equity Act](#) and its associated [Regulations](#) is to ensure that through proactive means, federally regulated organizations compensate employees who occupy positions in predominantly female job classes so that they receive equal compensation for work of equal value. Job classes equate to a classification group and [level](#). The Act and Regulations set out four criteria for determining whether the work is of equal value: the skill, effort, and responsibility required in the performance of the work, as well as the working conditions under which the work is performed.

2.1.3 The Classification Policy Suite

The Classification Policy Suite contains several policy instruments and their supporting tools (Directives):

- [Policy on People Management](#)
- [Policy of the Management of Executives](#) (EX Group)
- [Directive on Classification](#)
- [Directive on Executive \(EX\) Group Organization and Classification](#)
- [Directive on Classification Oversight](#)
- [Directive on Classification Grievances](#)

Positions classified in the EX Group have specific policy instruments which supersede other policy instruments.

2.1.3.1 Policy on People Management

The [Policy on People Management](#) and its supporting tools detail the roles and responsibilities of DHs, and the Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO) regarding OC.

The [Policy on People Management](#) delegates authority to:

The CHRO:

- Provides for the classification of positions in the CPA by making amendments to and determining the effective dates of JESs, occupational group, or [subgroup](#) definitions, and TBS Qualification Standards (QSs).
- Directs DHs regarding their OC responsibilities, HR management, and their oversight, systems, and reporting.
- Approves technical amendments to the policy and related instruments.
- Decides and responds to a grievance brought against a classification decision authorized by the deputy head concerned (for example, positions classified in the EX Group).

Deputy Heads:

Approve deputy head-directed classification decisions where the following three circumstances are met:

- They are approved in unique and exceptional circumstances only, where there is no clear and obvious fit with JES,
- They are used to support the development and testing of OC innovation solutions approved by the CHRO to address short-term critical workforce needs to meet rapidly changing business requirements, *and*
- They are not used to resolve grievances.

Sub-Delegation of [Classification Authority](#)

Deputy heads are accountable for overseeing the effective management and control of the OC program within their organizations.

The delivery of the OC program is enabled by the sub-delegation of classification authority. Policy on People Management delegates authority to DHs to sub-delegate classification decision-making authority, other than the authority to decide and respond to [classification grievances](#), only to [persons accredited](#) in OC within their organizations. Accredited and sub-delegated OC advisors analyze information from a variety of sources, including organizational structures and job descriptions (JDs) to make classification decisions.

Managers are accountable to deliver on their assigned mandates and to use public funds with probity and care in doing so. Managers organize work with guidance from their OC advisor, approve their organizational structures, the flow of work, and assign duties to their employees. It is the manager's responsibility to ensure that the selected JD reflects the duties that are assigned to their employees.

Each DH sets the parameters for the sub-delegation of authority within their organization through their own Instrument of HR sub-delegation in accordance with the [Policy on People Management](#) and its supporting

Directives, allowing for some differences in approach from one organization to another (for example, DHs may differ in the level of management they sub-delegate authorities to).

2.1.3.2 Policy on Management of Executives

The policy establishes the authorities and responsibilities of DHs and the CHRO for the effective management of executives, including EX Group OC, compensation, performance and talent management and other terms and conditions of executive employment across the core public administration. This policy may have specific requirements for position classified in the EX Group which supersede the Policy on People Management.

Deputy heads are solely responsible for and may not delegate approval of classification decisions and creation for EX Group positions on the recommendation of Head of Human Resources, in accordance with Appendix A.

The approval of classification decisions for EX Group positions must be informed by advice from a human resources advisor who has completed the training on EX Group classification prescribed by the OCHRO.

Under this Policy, OCHRO is delegated the authority for the following:

- Developing and maintaining the JES and related tools for the EX Group.
- Determining the requirements for training on EX Group classification.
- Determining if an investigation or remedial action(s) may be warranted with regards to compliance with this policy; and
- Directing specific actions to avoid or correct anomalies, or imposing consequences in cases of non-compliance, where warranted.

2.1.3.3 Directive on Classification

The [Directive on Classification](#) establishes the detailed requirements of the Classification Program, specifically that classification authority is properly exercised, that classification decisions are sound, and that OC activities are well managed. It details roles and responsibilities specific to heads of human resources, managers, persons accredited, and [persons trained in OC](#) (these roles and responsibilities are explored in greater detail in Chapters 4 and 5).

Appendix A of the [Directive on Classification](#) provides additional guidance for the use of deputy head-directed classification decisions.

Appendix B of the [Directive on Classification](#) (Standard on Classification) provides additional details on the following requirements:

- [Job descriptions](#): content, identifying information, and when they should be updated.
- [Reclassification](#): situations that constitute reclassifications, and those that do not.
- [Job evaluation committees](#): situations in which committees are required, and their composition.
- Job validation: situations in which [job validation reviews](#) are required.
- Documentation and data management: what information is required to substantiate a classification decision and to be retained in classification files, and in the Employer central system (PCIS+).

- Proactive disclosure: quarterly mandatory reporting requirements for decisions that result in a reclassification.
- The [Directive on Classification](#) does not apply to positions classified in the EX Group.

A summary of classification activities and appropriate authorized parties is shown in Figure 2.1.

Classification Activity	Authorized Party
Classification Actions	Persons Trained (Directive on Classification 4.4)
Classification Decisions	Accredited & Subdelegated OC Advisors only
Administrative Actions	Administrative Staff

Figure 2.1 Summary of classification activities and appropriate authorized parties.

2.1.3.4 Directive on Executive (EX) Group Organization and Classification

The [Directive on Executive \(EX\) Group Organization and Classification](#) describes the requirements for the organization and classification of positions in the Executive Group in the CPA.

Heads of HR may approve [classification actions](#) on behalf of the DH.

In the context of EX Classification, a classification action is a [classification activity](#) that does not require a new classification decision and does not have an impact on the position's surrounding organizational structure.

2.1.3.5 Directive on Classification Oversight

The [Directive on Classification Oversight](#) describes the responsibilities of Heads of Human Resources for the oversight of classification, including Executive Group (EX) classification. These include ensuring that an oversight function is implemented; ensuring that key OC risks are identified, assessed, prioritized and reported to the deputy head; providing monitoring reports and oversight information to OCHRO when requested; and developing and implementing corrective action plans in response to OCHRO requests.

Classification oversight includes both EX and non-EX classification. The objective of this directive is to contribute to prudent management of the wage bill for the CPA through effective oversight of the OC Program; to provide assurance that classification relativity is maintained, and that the integrity of the OC Program is safeguarded.

2.1.3.6 Directive on Classification Grievances

This directive outlines the recourse process for classification grievances.

2.2 The Classification Program

All organizations have a way to rank and compare work; in the CPA, the Classification Program serves this purpose. The program supports the CPA in establishing the relative value of work in an equitable, consistent,

and effective manner. The OC Program offers a base upon which other HR components, including staffing, pay and benefits, labour relations, HR planning, and official languages are anchored.

Financial implications: The OC Program framework has significant financial implications since the evaluation of positions (their group, sub-group, and level) is linked directly with corresponding collective agreements and their associated salary scales.

Relative value of work: The OC Program framework provides the infrastructure within which work is grouped and its relative worth evaluated.

Policy and legislative framework: The OC Program is framed by policy, directives and standards (for example, JESs) which guide OC within the CPA. The program:

- Establishes the classification group, sub-group (if applicable), and level related to the positions of more than 231,000 employees in many organizations across the CPA¹.
- Is comprised of 29 occupational groups represented by 17 bargaining agents².
- Is comprised of 72 JESs which are associated with 63 minimum qualification standards³.
- Has direct repercussions on a payroll in the billions of dollars.

2.2.1 Organizational design

The OC Program involves the two inter-related activities of organizational design and classification, each requiring complementary skills and knowledge.

Organizational design involves the provision of advice and guidance base on the analysis of the relationships between tasks, workflow, processes, responsibilities, and authorities within and between organizations (both existing and new), with a view to optimizing the efficiency with which the organization delivers on its objectives and mandate. This includes the distribution of work, roles and responsibilities within organizations; it aligns processes, systems, technology, culture, and people with the organization's goals.

A well-designed organization supports the achievement of its purpose or strategy, meets the challenges posed by business realities and significantly increases the likelihood that the collective efforts of people will be successful. Service design, which aims to optimize customer experiences with service providers, can inform the organization of work and enhance system-wide solutions.

2.2.2 Classification

Classification is the evaluation of job responsibilities within organizations, as outlined in JDs; this evaluation is a systematic way of determining the relative worth of jobs within the CPA; job descriptions specify the work activities assigned to positions by management and are one of the main tools used in [job evaluation](#). Job evaluation decisions are made by accredited and sub-delegated OC advisors, as experts in the OC framework.

¹ [Population of the federal public service](#)

² See Figure 2.2 Current Occupational Group Structure

³ [Job evaluation standards for public service employees](#)

2.2.3 Classification Decisions

A classification decision establishes or confirms the occupational group, subgroup (if applicable) and level assigned to a job. Classification decisions can only be rendered by accredited OC advisors with the appropriate sub-delegated authority; they analyze and evaluate the duties assigned to jobs, by using tools such as:

- Occupational group and subgroup definitions
- Job validation review (where applicable)
- Organizational structure and context
- Relevant JES
- Relativity analysis
- Job description

2.3 Occupational Group Structure

The OC Program organizes the work of the CPA into what is referred to as the occupational group structure (OGS). Occupational groups have been designed to group together similar types of work, each represented by a two-letter abbreviation. Figure 2.2 illustrates the current occupational group structure across the government, arranged by Bargaining Agent.

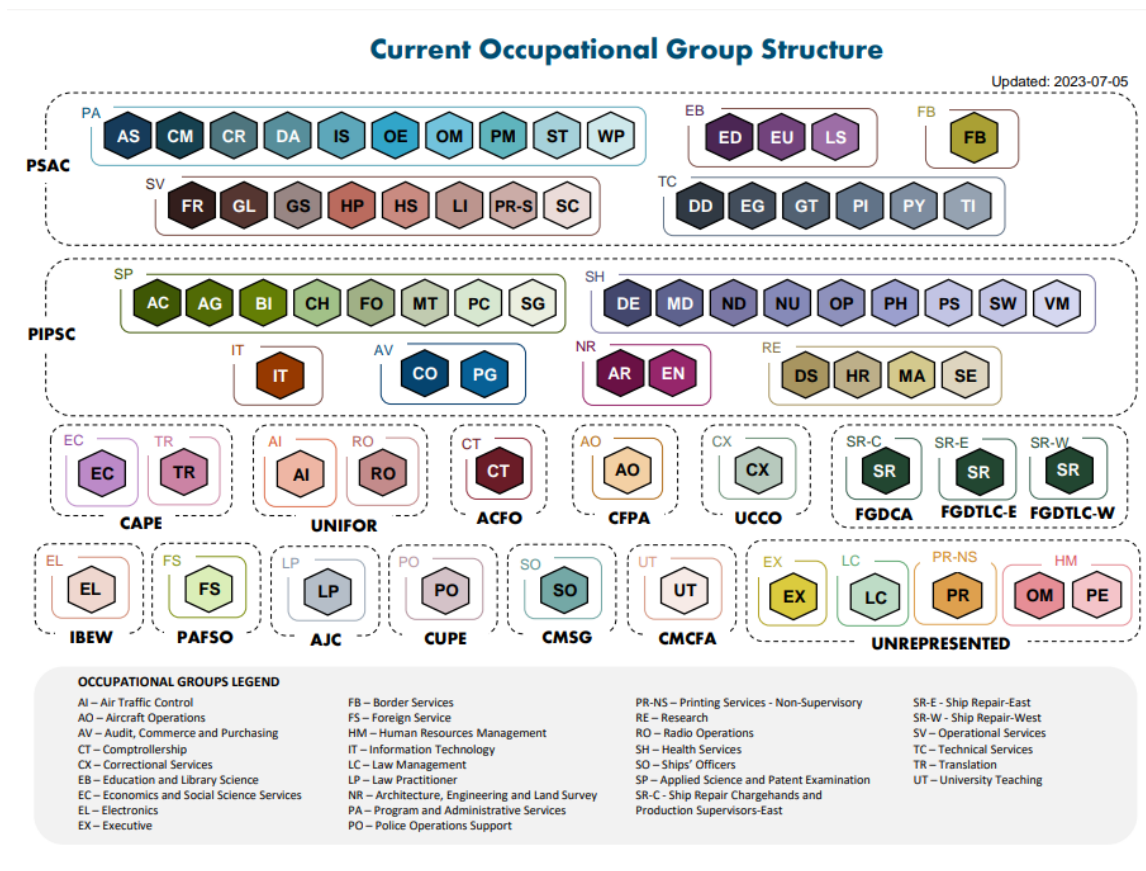


Figure 2.2 Current Occupational Group Structure

The [Table of Concordance](#) provides a mapping of, and links to, the occupational group (subgroup) definitions, their associated JESs, minimum Qualification Standards, collective bargaining information, and rates of pay.

Chapter 3 – Other HR Specialties and their Links with OC

Classification is the cornerstone of HR management; it has a direct impact on the ability of organizations to achieve expected outcomes.

Classification is a central component in sound people management. Collaboration between the various HR specialties is essential, as they are all linked to organization and classification (see Figure 3.1).



Figure 3.1 Other Human Resources Specialties Linked to Organizational Design and Classification

3.1 Compensation

Total compensation comprises the pay and benefits provided in collective agreements, other related benefits such as pensions, as well as intangibles such as organizational culture and learning opportunities. Classification decisions impact employee compensation both directly (pay scales are based on the classification group, subgroup if applicable, and level of each position) and indirectly (mandatory deductions for those occupying a position in a represented group, commonly referred to as union dues). Most occupational groups are represented by bargaining agents, who negotiate collective agreements with the Employer on behalf of their members.

3.2 Staffing

Staffing specialists provide advice to hiring managers on the most appropriate staffing mechanism for filling positions. They help managers to establish statements of merit criteria (SoMC), which are based on the duties assigned to positions (and described in JDs) and minimum Qualification Standards (although hiring managers have the latitude to require higher standards to be met).

Positions must be classified before they can be staffed, and job descriptions should be reviewed by management before positions are staffed to ensure cohesion between the job duties assigned and the competencies sought in staffing processes.

3.3 Labour Relations

Labour relations (LR) refers to the full spectrum of the relationship between employers and their employees, with LR specialists providing advice and support to managers regarding employer-employee relationships. Managers have the authority to assign duties and approve the content and effective date of job descriptions. Labour relations specialists are responsible for supporting management through the process associated with labour relations grievances, which include resolution of [job content grievances](#), which pertain to the content of JDs.

A position's classification includes its allocation to an occupational group and level, which is linked to its associated bargaining agent (BA), if applicable. The classification level also indirectly impacts the position's group status (whether the incumbent of the position is represented by a BA or unrepresented). Bargaining agents are certified to represent an occupational group by the Federal Public Sector Labour Relations and Employment Board (FPSLREB). [Excluded positions](#) are represented positions that have been removed from their bargaining unit due to the nature of their assigned duties; LR specialists are directly involved in supporting managers in negotiating their removal from representation with the respective BAs. Positions can be excluded because they are confidential, have substantial management functions, respond to grievances, or are in a conflict-of-interest situation for any other reason. Note that some occupational groups are unrepresented due to the nature of their work, for example executives, HR advisors, those involved in the collective bargaining process, etc. (these are the EX, PE, OM and LC groups).

3.4 Human Resources Planning

Integrated HR planning is the process of identifying current and future human capital needs of an organization as a whole or in part and involves the assessment of whether an organization has sufficient capacity, including skills, competencies, and human resources to achieve business objectives. Setting HR priorities and strategies helps achieve business goals, maintain capacity and close the identified gaps. The HR planning process is strongly linked to financial management and organizational design.

3.5 Official Languages

Official languages specialists support management in the implementation of, and compliance with, the [Official Languages Act](#) and its associated [Directive on Official Languages for People Management](#). Managers in the CPA are responsible for determining the linguistic identification of positions, and by extension the language proficiencies they seek when hiring employees. All positions have an associated official languages profile which is based on the duties assigned (JDs), and the context in which they are performed. As is the case with all internal operational processes (which are under the purview of DHs) internal processes surrounding official languages requirements vary between organizations.

3.6 Training and Learning

The training and development needs of employees are determined based on their roles and responsibilities as described in job descriptions, as well as the knowledge, skills, and competencies required to perform the work. This includes the identification of training specific to functional communities, and organization-specific mandatory training for employees. The [Directive on Mandatory Training](#) provides additional information.

3.7 Employment Equity

Employment Equity encourages the establishment of working conditions that are free of barriers. The [Employment Equity Act](#) was established to build a foundation for equal access to employment opportunities or benefits and to correct the conditions of disadvantage in employment experienced by designated groups. The Act requires organizations to identify barriers, and institute policies and practices to achieve representation in each occupational group in the workforce that reflects their representation in the Canadian workforce.

Chapter 4 – Other Stakeholders and Their Roles

Organizations in the CPA are responsible for managing OC functions in their respective organizations. In addition to employees whose duties are directly linked to OC, stakeholders include (but are not limited to):

- Deputy Heads (DHs)
- Heads of Human Resources (HoHR)
- Managers
- Bargaining Agents (BA)

4.1 Deputy Heads

Among other requirements, DHs:

- Must designate a HoHR for their organization to lead organizational human resources management duties.
- Can delegate classification authority, other than the authority to decide and respond to classification grievances, only to persons who are accredited in OC.
- Make deputy head-directed classification decisions, except for position classified in the EX Group, in accordance with the mandatory requirements in Appendix A of the [Policy on People Management](#).
- Have the authority to organize the work and classify positions in their respective organizations.

Regarding classification grievances, DHs are responsible for ⁴:

- Issuing final and binding classification grievance decisions for all classification levels, unless the classification decision was authorized by the deputy head concerned, in which case the grievance will be decided and responded to by the CHRO (this authority may be delegated to a senior official designated for classification grievances).
- Responding to grievors with regards to their classification grievances.
- Implementing final and binding classification grievance decisions⁵.

⁴ Section 4.1.10.5 of the [Policy on People Management](#)

⁵ Section A2.3 of the [Policy on People Management](#)

4.2 Heads of Human Resources

Heads of Human Resources must ensure that⁶:

- Jobs within the organization are classified in accordance with the Directive on Classification, JESs, occupational group and subgroup definitions, and guidance from the CHRO.
- Classification conversion and renaming initiatives are completed within the prescribed timelines and guidance established by the CHRO.
- Persons approving classification actions have completed mandatory training, developed by OCHRO.
- [Standardized job descriptions](#) (SJDs) are used appropriately. Unique jobs are used in exceptional circumstances only – such as where there are no applicable pre-classified jobs anywhere in the organization or the CPA.
- An internal process is established for the resolution of impasses and disagreements in classification decisions.
- The establishment of an appropriate approval level and process for effective dates carrying a long retroactivity period (that is, six months or more) are established.

Deputy head-directed decisions are used and administered in accordance with the mandatory procedures in Appendix A of the *Directive on Classification*.

- All classification actions, decisions and job records are tracked and recorded in the organization's HR system and are submitted to the CHRO's HR systems (PCIS+).
- Controls are in place for the management of vacant positions.

Some organizations have a Director of Organization and Classification, whose role supports that of the HoHR.

4.3 Managers

Managers must:

- Successfully complete the required training prior to exercising OC responsibilities.
- Seek advice from persons accredited in OC when proposing changes to their organizational structure.
- Provide all information required for rendering a classification decision and for completing classification actions.
- Implement [interdepartmental standardized job descriptions](#) (ISJDs) and departmental SJDs wherever possible.
- Maintain accurate organizational structures and current JDs for their area of responsibility.
- Determine evidence-based effective dates of JDs and justifying the dates chosen.
- Participate in job evaluation committees and in job validation reviews (JVRs), as required.
- Ensure that employees are notified each time a classification decision is rendered for the position they occupy.
- Upon receipt of a classification grievance, the manager (or immediate supervisor, or local officer-in-charge) must sign and date the grievance form, return the signed and dated copy of the grievance form to the grievor (or their representative, if any), and provide the grievance to the deputy

⁶ [Directive on Classification](#)

head (or in cases where responsibilities have been delegated, to the senior official designated for classification grievances).

4.4 Bargaining Agents (BA)

Bargaining agents are employee organizations that are certified by the [Federal Public Sector Labour Relations and Employment Board](#) (FPSLREB) to represent employees in a bargaining unit. Certification is granted for a specific bargaining unit, which generally corresponds to a group of positions within the employer's classification system. In the Government of Canada, public service bargaining agents represent the interests of employees in collective bargaining and participate in the resolution of workplace issues and rights disputes.

Chapter 5 - Individuals with OC Responsibilities

The role of individuals with OC responsibilities includes building and maintaining a professional partnership with client managers, keeping them informed throughout the OC process, and leveraging all the available flexibilities in the OC framework to respond to organizational need.

5.1 Persons Accredited in OC who have Sub-delegated Classification Authority

[Classification accreditation](#) is an attestation by the CHRO that an individual has successfully completed the requirements of the OC Learning Curriculum.

Classification decisions can be rendered by the deputy head, a senior official designated by the DH for classification grievances purposes, or an accredited person exercising classification authority (the power to authorize classification decisions); they establish or confirm the occupational group, subgroup (if applicable), level, and ratings assigned to a job.

An OCHRO accreditation is required for individuals to be sub-delegated the authority to render classification decisions on behalf of their Deputy Head. Upon being accredited, a unique alpha numeric identifier is granted to each OC advisor, which is transferable from one organization to another within the CPA. Sub-delegation (the authority to practice) must be granted by the DH of each organization before OC advisors can render classification decisions. Some organizations may require an additional practicum period and the presentation of additional material before granting sub-delegated authority to an accredited employee.

To make sound classification decisions, accredited and sub-delegated OC advisors must have a strong understanding of their organization and how it fits into the Government of Canada context. Accredited and sub-delegated OC advisors should have an awareness of:

- the Clerk's priorities
- organizational mandates, programs and business lines (found on websites, program documentation, from clients directly, etc.).
- the range of executive level responsibilities in the organization.
- the organizational context / work environment (for example if the work is performed in a regional or headquarters context)

Persons accredited in OC and who have sub-delegated classification authority are responsible for⁷:

- Evaluating jobs and approving classification decisions.
- Providing OC advice.
- Participating in job evaluation committees.

5.2 Persons Trained in OC

Persons who have completed the mandatory OCHRO training are responsible for processing and approving classification **actions: these** do not impact or modify classification decisions. They consist of the creation of a position using an SJD; the deletion of a position; and the modification of the reporting relationship or title of a position⁸. A [person trained in OC](#), in the sense described here, cannot proceed with such actions if they may impact the classification decision being applied; in these situations, an accredited OC advisor must assess whether the decision is impacted.

5.3 Persons Trained in EX Group Classification

Persons trained in EX Group classification are responsible for:

- Evaluating EX Group jobs and providing advice on classification decisions.
- Providing OC advice.
- Participating in or chairing job evaluation committees.

Persons trained must have experience in classification and have completed the required training on the *Executive Group Job Evaluation Standard*.

To recommend appropriate and sound classification decision to the DH, the persons trained in OC require similar understanding and awareness as the accredited and sub-delegated OC advisors discussed above.

Chapter 6 – Job Descriptions

The roles of client managers and their OC advisors are complementary; the exchange of information is crucial to the success of both. Two documents that provide key information are job descriptions and [organizational charts](#).

Managers at all levels, along with OC advisors, have a role to play regarding OC. This reference guide presents the basic principles of job descriptions to assist the OC advisor in performing their duties and in fulfilling their responsibilities in this field.

Organizations are comprised of positions to which duties are assigned. The organizational structure provides an overview of the organization's positions and their authorities.

The purpose of job descriptions is to:

- Define the duties assigned to jobs within an organization.

⁷ [Directive on Classification](#)

⁸ Section 4.4 of the [Directive on Classification](#), Module 2

- Enable the evaluation of jobs: identifying the occupational group, (or sub-group if applicable), level, and by extension the associated salary range.

Benefits of Accurate and Up-To-Date Job Descriptions

Accurate JDs clarify the [key activities](#), roles, duties, responsibilities, and reporting relationships for positions in an organization, contributing to organizational effectiveness. Managers must ensure that the JDs they select reflect the work they assign to positions. Upon changing circumstances, managers must re-assess if the JD of a position remains appropriate, or if another JD should be selected.

Job descriptions describe the duties and responsibilities concisely, using bias-free language that respect the requirements of the *Pay Equity Act*. For positions classified in the EX Group, job descriptions must be updated and evaluated within one year when affected by significant changes, including but not limited to mandate, organizational structure, dimensions or reporting relationships⁹.

Where no pre-classified jobs across the CPA are already describing the work, a new JD is evaluated by an accredited and sub-delegated OC advisor. When the job evolves or changes, **before creating a new decision**, the OC advisor must search the CPA to find a pre-classified, best fit job that meets the changed circumstances.

Occasionally, it may be necessary for OC advisors to work with community leaders to conceptualize and establish new jobs in cases of new, emerging work.

Maintaining accurate and up-to-date JDs:

- Ensures clarity of roles, letting employees know what is expected of them (that is, as per collective agreements). They also inform work objectives.
- Allows managers to choose from existing pre-classified jobs (if available) as the work changes to ensure that the described functions remain current.
- Facilitates the development of SoMCs and conditions of employment for staffing processes.
- Clarifies career paths.
- Ensures that employees are compensated appropriately for the work that they perform.

6.2 Job Descriptions: Roles and Responsibilities

Managers, OC specialists, and employees all have roles and responsibilities with regards to job descriptions.

- **Managers:** organize the work within their units/teams, select the pre-classified JDs that best describe work assigned, and when the work changes, promptly selects a different pre-classified JD, as needed; with advice from OC advisors. They also establish evidence-based effective dates. Managers are also responsible to discuss how the content of the job applies within the specific context of the organization with the employee. When the job changes, managers must signify in writing any work that starts or ceases and re-engage with employees when a new JD is applied to their job.
- **OC advisors:** advise and challenge managers on effective date and selection of most appropriate ISJD, SJD or JD, provide clarification on their content; perform analyses; recommend strategies, approaches, and effective, proactive solutions in response to identified challenges. Advisors must appropriately

⁹ [Directive on Executive \(EX\) Group Organization and Classification](#)

document all information supporting effective dates and implement the classification decision commensurate with the effective date. It should be noted that persons trained in OC could provide support to managers in the application of ISJDs and SJDs.

- **Employees:** read, understand and discuss the content of their JD with their manager to ensure they know what is expected of them. Should they be invited to a job validation review exercise, employees discuss the specifics of the jobs with the OC advisor, to support best understanding of the functions for evaluation purposes.

6.3 Job Description links to HR activities

Compensation: Job evaluation, informed by JDs, determines the occupational group, (sub-group) and level, linking to a negotiated salary range.

Staffing: The duties described in JDs are used to develop SoMCs and assessment tools.

On-Boarding: Job descriptions allow employees to better understand their roles and responsibilities.

Labour Relations: Collective agreements entitle employees to up-to-date JDs.

Performance Management: Job descriptions inform the development of work objectives, from which performance agreements are established.

Training: Job descriptions can help identify the knowledge/competencies and mandatory training required for the job.

6.4 Effective Dates of Job Descriptions

Effective dates indicate when the duties described in the JD were officially assigned. Managers are responsible for establishing evidence-based effective dates that are consistent with the assignment of duties to employees.

Note: in EX classification, effective dates should not be retroactive more than one year.

6.5 Unique and Standardized Job Descriptions

JDs are either unique or standardized.

6.6.1 [Unique Job Descriptions](#)

Requirements

Unique job descriptions:

- Are rare and used exclusively when only one (1) person does this work across the enterprise (CPA).
- Are distinct from all other jobs in the CPA in both their work and evaluation.
- Are never the default option when a job description is sought.

Note on unique jobs: prior to creating a new decision, all efforts must be made by OC advisors to find an applicable existing decision across the CPA, to reduce redundant decisions at the Enterprise level.

6.6.2 Standardized Job Descriptions

Requirements:

Standardized Job Descriptions:

- SJDs/ISJDs are developed to apply as-is, in as many organizational contexts as possible, and must be used wherever they apply.
- When applying an SJD/ISJD, if the context is included in the Application Criteria, it can be applied as-is.
- When applying an SJD/ISJD in a new organizational context, it must be analyzed by an accredited OC advisor to ensure that the decision continues to apply in that new context.
 - If the decision continues to apply:
 - the SJD/ISJD can be applied as is and
 - the Application Criteria associated with the SJD/ISJD must be expanded to include the new context, enabling its application in a wider variety of organizational contexts.
 - If the decision does not apply, a new decision must be rendered.

Benefits of SJDs

Standardized Job Descriptions:

- Reduce the administrative burden, cost and total number of JDs in an organization, allowing faster creation and update of positions. They greatly improve the operational capacity of OC team.
- Support the streamlining of competency profiles, learning plans, and statements of merit criteria. They also enable the development of comprehensive and effective professional development and recruitment processes.
- Facilitate assignment and deployment processes and clarify career paths for employees.
- Enable easier comparison of positions within the organization and across the CPA.
- Standardize work and work practices across teams, providing improved transparency.

Myths of developing and using SJDs

- The effort and initial cost to develop SJDs is too high: The savings in time and effort are significant in the longer term, when SJDs are available for faster position creation without the need to develop similar unique JDs. NOTE: before creating new SJDs in an organization, look for similar pre-classified work in other organizations across the CPA to use.
- Employees may feel that their work is not well reflected in an SJD: This perception can be managed using language in SJDs that is general, but still relevant to the employee's work. If the employees cannot relate to the duties as described, then the SJD may have been written too broadly or perhaps another SJD is more suitable.

6.6.3 Interdepartmental Standardized Job Descriptions:

ISJDs are SJDs that apply across the enterprise, where all positions are classified at the same occupational group, sub-group (if applicable), and level, and are applied within pre-established organizational contexts. They are validated by OCHRO, and a unique alpha-numeric number is applied to the decision (for example GN12345).

ISJDs can be created by OCHRO in collaboration with functional communities, by OCHRO when there are no clear functional communities, or are identified through Oversight as ISJDs.

Chapter 7 - Organizational Charts

Organizational charts visually represent the reporting structure of positions in an organization and their relationship to the other positions (above, below, and adjacent) in the same unit or division. They show the lines of authority and functional links within an organization that support the achievement of the organization's business objectives.

Managers are responsible for ensuring that their organizational chart is reflective of their current reality. If there is a discrepancy between the official HR system of records and their organizational chart, the discrepancies must be promptly corrected in the system.

Accurate organizational charts contribute to data integrity in HR and associated systems (such as Phoenix), facilitating the work of managers and HR alike.

Organizational charts:

- Must be up to date, signed and dated.
- Help to clarify the hierarchical relationships among the various roles in the organization.
- Depict the organizational structure to fulfill the assigned mandate and achieve business objective.
- Illustrate for employees the links between their jobs and other jobs within the organization, the division and the program.
- Make it easier to clarify how roles and responsibilities are shared, and to give context to assigned duties.
- Are used when analyzing the budget, designing work teams, and assigning tasks.

Chapter 8 – The Classification Decision Process

The nature of OC work varies depending on the client's needs. An overview of the classification decision process is presented in Figure 8.1.

While the process is presented in a linear fashion, the evaluation process rarely is. The order of the steps may vary, and some may not be included at all, depending on the case. The sequence of steps to be completed can be influenced by:

- The nature of the request.
- The information available.
- The timelines associated with a step (for example, time to receive relativity from other organizations).
- The need for a step (for example, need for a JVR, or a job evaluation committee).

Other information gathered during the process could also influence the sequence, requiring additional steps.

Subsequent reference guides explore the classification decision process in more detail.

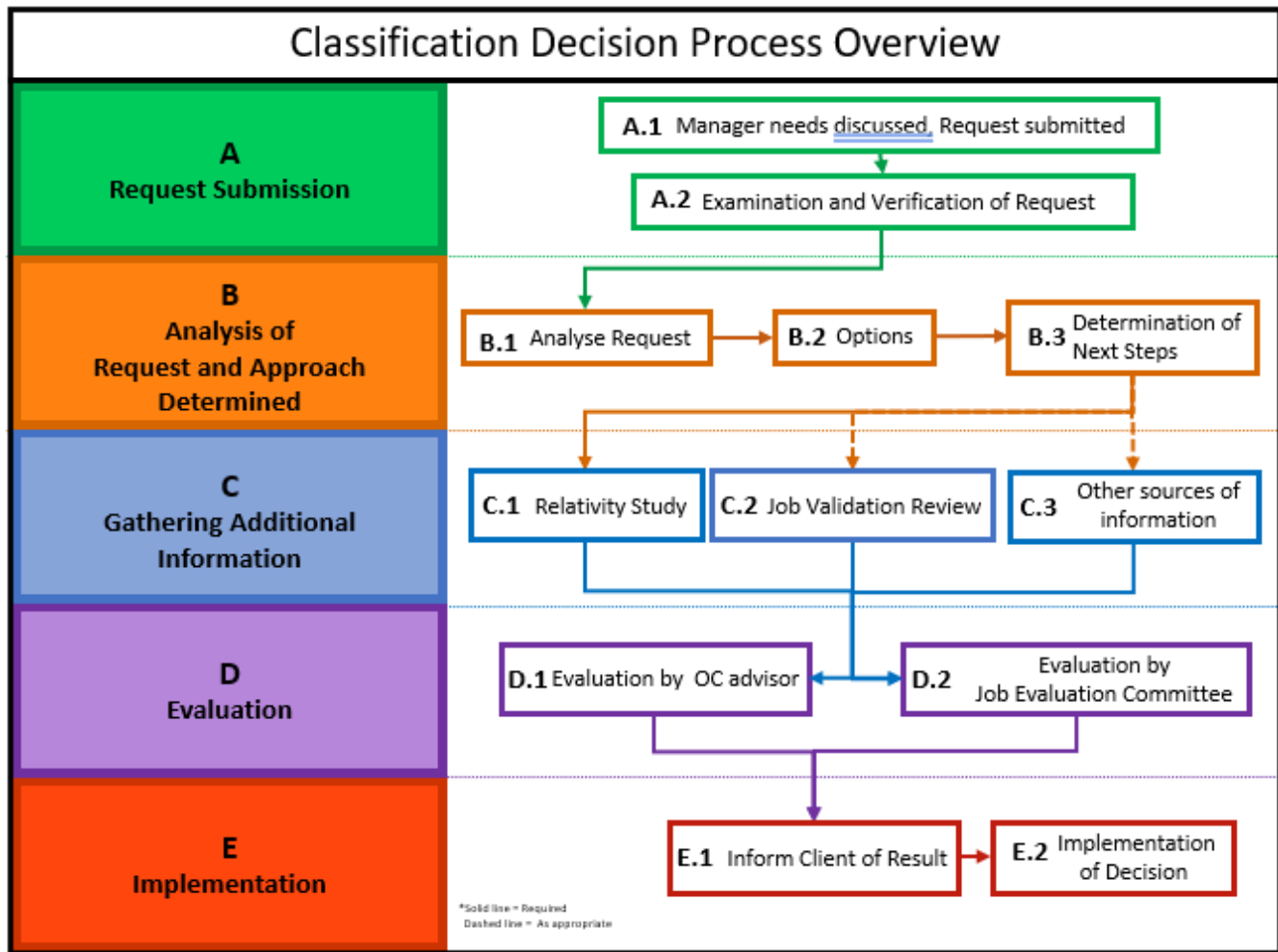
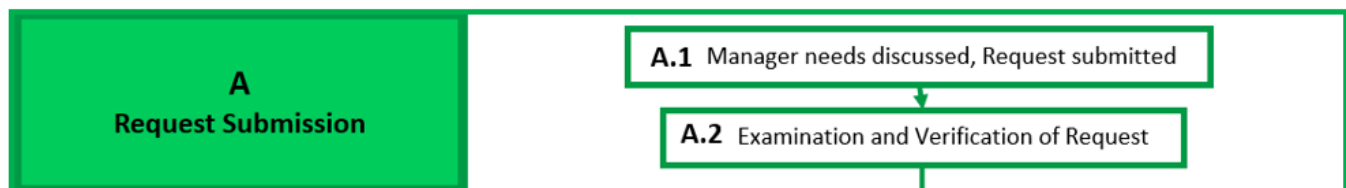


Figure 8.1 – Classification Decision Process Overview

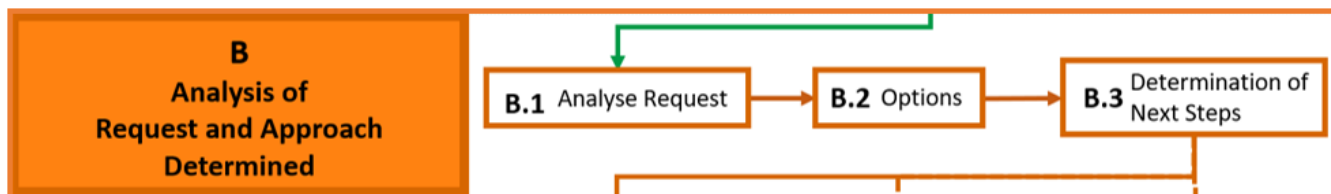
8.1 Request Submission



Ideally, the OC advisor engages in proactive discussions with the client, focusing on client goals. Frequent discussions build relationships and trust and enable sound solutions to be generated. While many organizations use a request system, it is only one of many ways to document management approval of the requested classification activity. For each classification activity, managers are responsible for submitting the appropriate documentation and assigning work as described in the selected JD.

At a minimum, all classification decisions require the selection of the appropriate (standardized) job description and organizational chart, signed and dated by the requesting manager. Organizational charts are a source of information to help represent the organizational context in which the duties described in the JD are carried out.

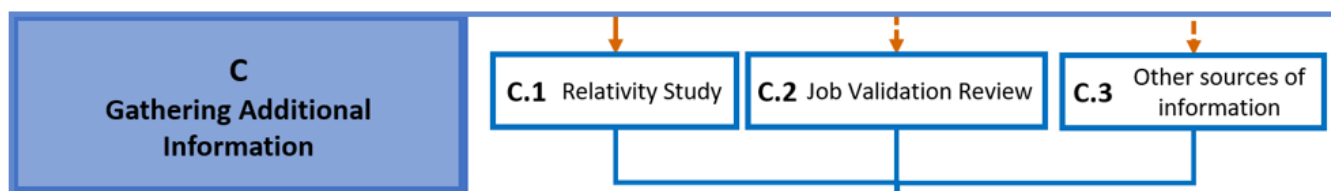
8.2 Analysis of the Request



The process begins with the analysis of the documentation submitted, to determine three main things:

- Whether the action requested is in fact the most appropriate to address the client's needs.
- Whether the selected SJD- ISJD is appropriate in the context, or a different one could be proposed.
- Whether additional information is required before next steps.

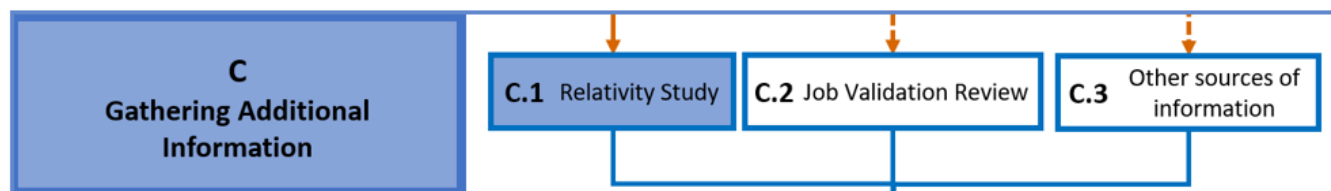
8.3 Gathering Additional Information



After analyzing the available information, if more information is required to adequately evaluate the position, the OC advisor can acquire this information through:

- A relativity study;
- A job validation review; or
- Other sources of information.

8.3.1 Relativity Study



A classification relativity study involves searching for and comparing the position(s) being evaluated with similar jobs, in similar organizational contexts within and outside the organization (departmental relativity and interdepartmental relativity).

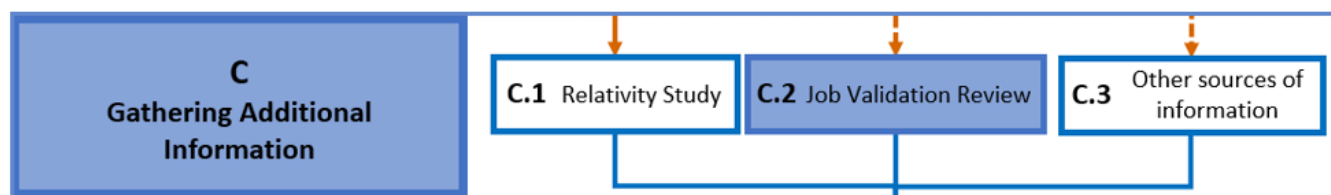
Why relativity matters:

- It demonstrates how differences and similarities in functions or contexts impact the ratings of the relative positions, allowing for a comparison with the evaluation underway.

- It provides an additional perspective to every evaluation decision which serves to deepen the understanding of the enterprise-wide context of the type of work that is being evaluated.

Job functions are reviewed in their organizational context. This means that the functions associated with the subject position must be reviewed in relation to the other positions in its organization (branch, directorate, sector/agency and even the Public Service), to determine how they fit into the workflows already in place. Managerial positions (including those in the EX group) and mandates should also be reviewed to understand the broader context of the job's assigned functions. A summary of the analysis of departmental and interdepartmental classification relativity must be recorded in the classification file for all classification decisions.

8.3.2 Job Validation Review (JVR)



A JVR is a fact-finding exercise (interview, questionnaire, et cetera) where the OC advisor discusses the duties performed, usually with the incumbent(s) of a job. The JVR facilitates a deeper understanding of the mandate, the work environment, and the duties. One purpose of a JVR is to determine if there is coincidence between the duties assigned as described in the job description, and those assigned to, and performed by the incumbent(s). JVRs enable a fully informed evaluation.

Requirements

JVRs are mandatory when^{10,11}:

- A proposed or possible reclassification may occur.
- A better understanding of the job is needed.

Best Practice

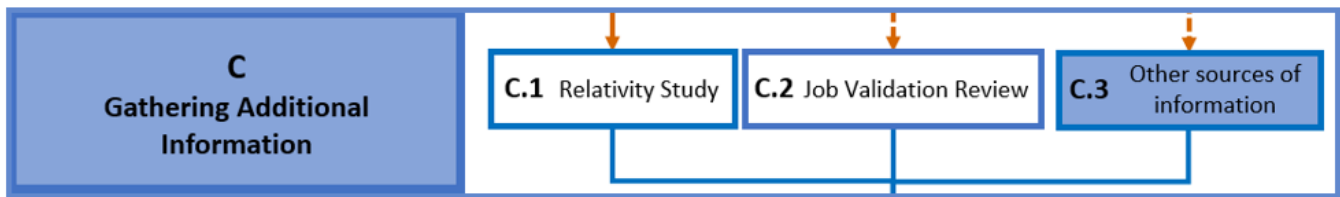
A JVR should be conducted when a classification grievance has been submitted, if one has not already been conducted.

The JVR report summarizes the information obtained and includes the job facts relevant to the evaluation of the position, as well as any recommendations the OC advisor makes to their client. The manager and the incumbent(s) should be given the opportunity to review the content of the report, to validate understanding of the job before the report is finalized.

¹⁰ Section B.2.2.8 of the [Directive on Classification](#)

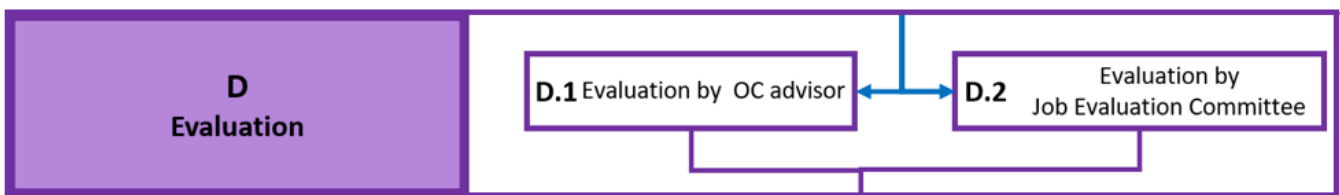
¹¹ JVRs are not required for EX classification

8.3.3 Other Sources of Information



This refers to any other source of information that could inform the evaluation of the job. Other sources also include information from the client manager (and similar partners across the enterprise), program or organizational mandate statements or reports, internal or external web sites, memorandums of understanding, communication strategies, Mandate Letters, Treasury Board Submissions, Memoranda to Cabinet, consultant's assessments, examples of work, et cetera.

8.4 Job Evaluation



Job evaluation consists of the evaluation of the duties described in job descriptions, in their organizational contexts.

8.4.1 Allocating Jobs to Occupational Groups

The first step in job evaluation is the allocation of the job to the appropriate occupational group (and sub-group, as appropriate).

The [Guide to Allocating Positions Using the Occupational Group Definitions](#) provides guidance on allocating work in the Public Service to occupational groups using the occupational group definitions. It also provides background information on the nature of the occupational groups and their definitions. Figure 8.2 provides an overview of the procedure to follow when allocating occupational group.

The occupational group definitions, along with the inclusion and exclusion statements can be found in the [Table of Concordance](#), which clarifies the occupational groups for the CPA.

The [Table of Concordance](#) is an effective tool to distinguish between the different occupational groups.

For example, the HM group (Human Resources Management) includes the Organization and Methods (OM) and Personnel Administration (PE) classifications (no sub-group) (Figure 8.3A).

The Education and Library Science (EB) group comprises the Education (ED), Educational Support (EU), and Library Science (LS) classifications. The ED classification is broken down further and contains the Education Services (ED-EDS), Elementary and Secondary Teaching (ED-EST), and Language Teaching (ED-LAT) sub-groups.

The EU is similarly subdivided into the Language Instructor (EU-LAI), Physical Education Instructor (EU-PEI), and the Teachers' Aide (TEA) sub-groups; whereas the LS classification has no sub-group (Figure 8.3B).

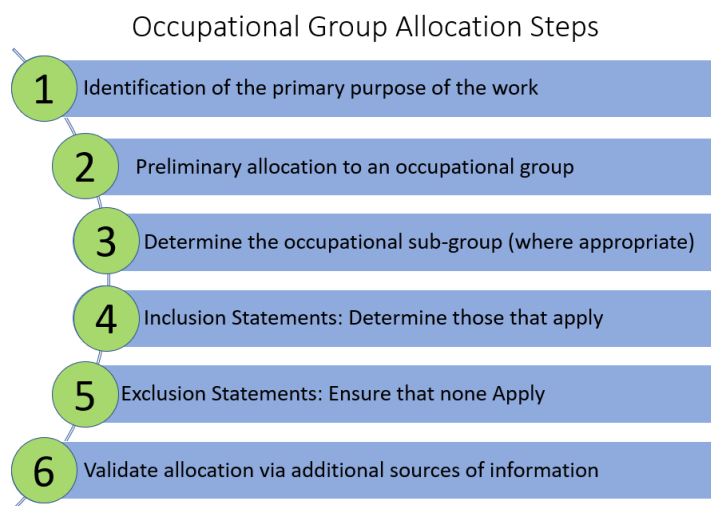


Figure 8.2 Overview of occupational group allocation procedure

A			B		
Group	Classification	Sub-group	Group	Classification	Sub-group
<u>Human Resources Management (HM)</u>	N/A	N/A	<u>Education and Library Science (EB)</u>	N/A	N/A
Human Resources Management (HM)	<u>Organization and Methods (OM)</u>	N/A	Education and Library Science (EB)	<u>Education (ED)</u>	N/A
Human Resources Management (HM)	<u>Personnel Administration (PE)</u>	N/A	Education and Library Science (EB)	Education (ED)	Education Services (ED-EDS)
			Education and Library Science (EB)	Education (ED)	Elementary and Secondary Teaching (ED-EST)
			Education and Library Science (EB)	Education (ED)	Language Teaching (ED-LAT)
			Education and Library Science (EB)	<u>Educational Support (EU)</u>	N/A
			Education and Library Science (EB)	Educational Support (EU)	Language Instructor (EU-LAI)
			Education and Library Science (EB)	Educational Support (EU)	Physical Education Instructor (EU-PEI)
			Education and Library Science (EB)	Educational Support (EU)	Teachers' Aide (EU-TEA)
			Education and Library Science (EB)	<u>Library Science (LS)</u>	N/A

8.4.2 Job Evaluation Standards (JES)

Job evaluation standards are developed and published by TBS; they are work measurement tools that form the basis for consistency in job evaluation, ensuring that the relative value of work is respected across the core public administration. The “notes to raters” that are included in each JES must be read carefully to ensure that the standard is properly applied and interpreted.

Once allocated to an occupational group, and sub-group as appropriate, the duties are evaluated, and its level established by applying the associated JES. In most cases, [benchmark](#) (BM) positions are provided to support the evaluation. Each JES follows a specific job evaluation plan.

The CPA uses four types of [job evaluation plans](#):

- Point rating
- Level determinant
- Predominant degree
- Incumbent oriented

The OC framework is position-based, meaning that it evaluates the duties assigned to a job, rather than the person performing them; the only exceptions to this are those jobs allocated to occupational groups whose JESs follow incumbent oriented job evaluation plans.

Point Rating

The point job evaluation plan is the most common evaluation method in the CPA. Every factor or element that is evaluated is divided into degrees of complexity, each of which is allotted points. Jobs are classified by linking the duties and responsibilities set out in the job description with the appropriate degree for each evaluation factor or element. The corresponding points are then compiled, and the total points compared to the point ranges in the JES to determine the job’s level.

Examples of occupational groups that use this type of JES are Administrative Services (AS), Clerical and Regulatory (CR), Information Technology (IT), Financial Management (FI), and Personnel Administration (PE).

Level Description

The level description job evaluation plan is less common. To classify jobs this way, a job is assigned to a level by determining which level description best corresponds overall with the duties and responsibilities of a job.

Examples of occupational groups that use this type of JES are: Architecture and Town Planning (AR), Engineering and Land Survey – Engineering (EN-ENG), Information Services (IS), Mathematics (MA), and Translation (TR)

Predominant Degree

The predominant degree job evaluation plan is used by relatively few JESs; they use a method resembling the point job evaluation plan in that the duties of the job are rated and given a degree for each factor. Instead of compiling the points, the level is determined based on the degree most often attributed to the factors overall. Example: Commerce (CO), Biological Sciences (BI), Chemistry (CH), Physical Sciences (PC), Psychology (PS) and Veterinary Medicine (VM).

Incumbent Oriented

The duties are allocated to an occupational group and sub-group, but the classified level of the job is determined through a review board based on the productivity and achievement of the individual employee (incumbent) performing the duties. When a new person is appointed to the position, the classification level is to be re-evaluated based on this same process.

Examples of occupational groups that use this type of JES are: Defense Scientists (DS), Historical Research (HR) and University Teaching (UT).

8.4.3 Job Evaluation by a Single Evaluator vs. by a Job Evaluation Committee

A job can be evaluated by either:

- A single evaluator (OC advisor); or
- A job evaluation committee.

A job evaluation committee is required when^{12,13}:

- Evaluating new standardized job descriptions.
- There is the likelihood of a reclassification.
- Introducing an occupational group or sub-group for the first time in an organization.
- The evaluation outcome may have a significant impact on departmental and interdepartmental relativity or result in a significant increase of salary expenditures.
- The evaluation outcome could be contentious or precedent-setting.

Job evaluation committees are appropriate in several circumstances and will be explored in subsequent reference guides.

The composition of the job evaluation committee is defined as including¹⁴ :

- At least one member who is designated as the Chair.
- A minimum of three rating members who are trained in job evaluation including one who is accredited and sub-delegated in OC.
- One or more rating members who represent(s) the organizations that use the ISJD/SJD, if applicable.
- Members who are not in a real or perceived conflict of interest.

¹² Section B.2.2.6 of the [Directive on Classification](#)

¹³ Note that job evaluation committees are not required for EX classification.

¹⁴ Section B.2.2.7 of the [Directive on Classification](#)

Job evaluation committees differ from the single-evaluator process in the following ways:

- During the committee:
 - Evaluators bring preliminary evaluations to the committee.
 - The sponsoring manager may present to and answer questions from the committee.
 - The committee must reach consensus on the evaluation.
 - All committee members must sign the job evaluation committee report to finalize the committee decision.

Best Practice

While it is a best practice to use job evaluation committees for the evaluation of positions classified in the EX Group, there is no stated requirement in the [Policy on the Management of Executives](#) or the related [Directive on Executive \(EX\) Group Organization and Classification](#) that compels departments to classify with committees.

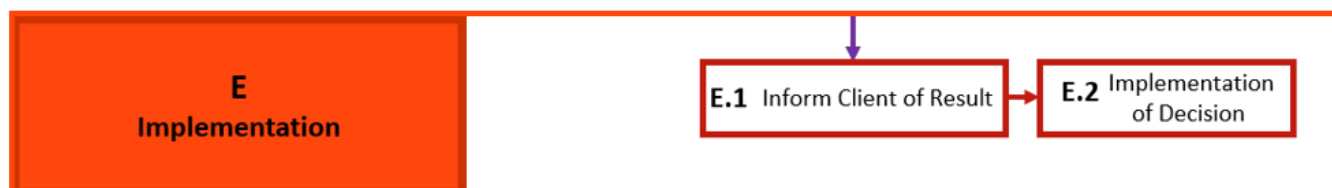
8.4.4 Job Evaluation Committee Report and Rationale

After the evaluation is completed, a document is produced to justify the classification decision. This is either a Job Evaluation Rationale (written by a single evaluator) or a Job Evaluation Committee Report (typically written by the committee Chair). The Job Evaluation Committee Report includes all the components of a single-evaluator job evaluation rationale, with the addition of other sections relating to the committee proceedings (list of members, presentation from management, committee deliberations). Job Evaluation Committee Reports must be approved and signed by all rating members of the committee.

Effective practices that support robust stewardship of the classification framework in the CPA and contribute to defensible classification decisions:

- Discussions with the clients to better understand and meet their needs.
- Ensuring organizational charts are accurate and up to date.
- Using existing ISJDs and SJDs where applicable.
- Ensuring the selection of effective dates that are evidence-based.
- Conducting a job validation review, if applicable, to verify coincidence between the duties performed and those described in selected JDs.
- Applying rigour in the methodology, the analysis, and the argumentation.

8.5 Implementation



When the decision is implemented, the job description and its associated evaluation is linked to one or more positions. This process involves data entry into the organization's HR information management system and the upload of the job record (JD, Rationale, Org Chart) in the Employer central position information system (PCIS+) and then, if the position is encumbered, the employee is notified of the result in writing.

Note: Job Evaluation Rationales and Committee Reports contribute to managers' and employees' understanding of all the aspects of the work considered in making the decision. Relativities of interest should also be included (example: positions in other organizations which have similar duties and have been evaluated at a specific group and level). Explanations provided by the OC advisor to both managers and employees serve to foster decision transparency and good client relations.

Chapter 9 – Review and Update of a Position

The duties assigned to positions may change, either as a result of changes in operational or organizational requirements, the organization's mandate, or as a result of the introduction of new programs or types of work. New technologies can also lead to changes in duties, as can the addition or removal of responsibilities. A change in organizational structure can also result in changes to a position's evaluation.

When duties change significantly or when new duties are assigned to a position, another SJD which reflects the duties is selected.¹⁵ The OC advisor determines whether the change in duties consists of a natural evolution within the same line of work. If so, a review and update is appropriate (which could result in a reclassification, up or down). If the degree of change breaks the natural evolution of the work, then a new position is created.

Note: Workload is not used to assess the value of a position, and therefore an increase in workload does not require a review of a position's duties. It may require creating additional positions to deliver on the increased workload.

9.1 Reclassification

A job evaluation that results in a reclassification may occur only as a result of¹⁶:

- Oversight, including corrective measures, or the proactive correction of an error.
- A grievance decision.
- A reorganization of work or a substantial change in duties or responsibilities (natural evolution within same work continuum).
- Legislative or policy changes that result in program or organizational changes.

The following situations do *not* constitute a reclassification¹⁷:

- Jobs/individuals are transferred from non-core public administration organizations to the CPA.
- Jobs/individuals are transferred by legislation to the core public administration.
- A change to the minimum Qualification Standards established in accordance with subsection 30(2) of the *Public Service Employment Act*.

Additional considerations:

- It is a best practice to conduct job validation reviews and use job evaluation committees for the reclassification of EX Group jobs. However it is not a stated requirement in the *Policy on the Management of Executives* or the *Directive on Executive (EX) Group Organization and Classification*.

¹⁵ Section B.2.2.3 of the [Directive on Classification](#)

¹⁶ Section B.2.2.4 of the [Directive on Classification](#)

¹⁷ Section B.2.2.5 of the [Directive on Classification](#)

- When reclassification is proposed or possible, a job validation review, and an evaluation by committee are required.

Chapter 10 – Financial Impacts of Organizational Design and Classification

OC has significant financial impacts because of its links to the salary wage envelop of Organizations. Changes to the organizational design and JDs may change classification evaluation outcomes, resulting in changes in the salary scales that jobs are associated with.

Financially delegated managers are accountable to spend allotted budget in a way to deliver mandated outcomes while being good stewards of public funds. OC advisors are accountable to appropriately classify assigned work, using the TB approved instruments (JES). Together, these roles yield sound stewardship and use of public funds.

- Creating positions implies that, upon staffing, there will be an enduring cost to the organization, at least for the time in which the position is encumbered. This cost includes the salary and benefits, which encompasses allotted pensions.
- The appropriate classification of work supports both attracting and maintaining a qualified workforce, the efficient delivery of organizational mandates, and ensures results for Canadians.
- The classification of a job determines the occupational group to which it belongs and identifies the associated bargaining agent (if applicable) certified by the FPSLREB. By extension, classification decisions impact the mandatory deductions (union dues) for those occupying positions in a represented group.

Note: If the duties were assigned by management and performed by the employee, financial impacts cannot be a reason to avoid reviewing the job.

OC advisors are experts in the infrastructure and measure of job value. The methodology and analysis used to assess and classify work requires rigour to deliver defensible decisions. That said, JESs are designed and tested to minimize user errors (less than 10%), so that application of sound methodology will deliver intended outcomes.

Chapter 11 – Management Disagreement with a Classification Decision

Each organization must establish its own internal process for the resolution of impasses and disagreements, between the expected outcomes of the manager, and the results of classification evaluation of duties, and related decision.¹⁸ Internal resolution processes vary between organizations.

If the client manager is not satisfied with the result of a job evaluation, the OC advisor:

- explains the decision and how the JES values the work in detail, and
- demonstrates how the provided information was considered.

If the client manager remains dissatisfied with the result, then the relevant organizational process for resolving impasses and disagreements is explained.

¹⁸ [*Directive on Classification*](#)

Chapter 12 – Grievances

12.1 Classification Grievances

Who can present a classification grievance?

- The [Federal Public Sector Labour Relations Act](#) determines who has the right to grieve. This right is provided, but not limited, to those employed in the core public administration, and it excludes, among others:
- Persons employed on a casual basis;
- Persons employed on a term basis for less than three months; and
- Persons required to work less than one third of the normal period for persons doing similar work.

Roles and Responsibilities:

- **Employees** must present a classification grievance within 35 calendar days after the day on which they receive notification or, where the employee has not received such notification, no later than 35 calendar days after the day on which they first become aware of an action or circumstance affecting the classification of the position he or she occupies. A classification grievance is presented in writing to the employee's immediate supervisor or local officer-in-charge.
- **Deputy Heads** respond to grievors and implement final and binding classification grievance decisions¹⁹.
- **Office of the Chief Human Resources Officer:** if the grievance pertains to a classification decision authorized by the DH, the grievance officer from OCHRO will chair the Classification Committee.²⁰
- **Heads of HR** ensure that a response to the grievor(s) is provided no later than 80 calendar days after the date the classification grievance was presented.

12.2 Labour Relations (LR) Grievances

Grievances relating to job content or effective dates are LR grievances.

A job content grievance is a written complaint submitted by an employee regarding the completeness and accuracy of their statement of duties (which include, among other tools, the job description).

A grievance pertaining to the effective date of the job description is a separate type of LR grievance.

Issues relating to these grievance types are resolved through the LR grievance procedure provided for in collective agreements.

¹⁹ [Policy on People Management](#), A2.2 and A2.3

²⁰ [Policy on People Management](#)